Scott Partington

sp933@cam.ac.uk · scottpartington.com

Research

AOS Moral Psychology, Philosophy of Cognitive Science, Philosophy of AI
AOC General Philosophy of Science, Philosophy of Biology, Philosophy of Mind

Education

University of Cambridge, Queens' College 2022–(expected April 2027)
PhD in Philosophy of Science
Supervisor: Prof. Marta Halina

University of Cambridge, Fitzwilliam College 2021–2022
MPhil in Philosophy of Science

Cornell University 2016–2020
B.A. in Psychology and College Scholar

University of Cambridge, Fitzwilliam College 2018–2019
Visiting student in Psychological & Behavioural Sciences

Publications

Partington, S. (forthcoming). The evaluative niche hypothesis. *Philosophy of Science*.

Partington, S., Kamtekar, R., Nichols, S. (2025). Norms emerge through iterated learning. *PNAS*. doi:10.1073/pnas.2504178122

Vesga, A., **Partington, S.**, Pizarro, D., Nichols, S. (2025). Explaining value. *Mind & Language*. doi:10.1111/mila.70006

Partington, S., Vesga, A., Nichols, S. (2023). No brute facts. *Cognition*. doi:10.1016/j.cognition.2023.105479

Partington, S., Nichols, S., Kushnir, T. (2023). Rational learners and parochial norms. *Cognition*. doi:10.1016/j.cognition.2022.105366

Awards and scholarships

Arnold Gerstenberg Studentship, University of Cambridge 2021–2026

HPS Department Maintenance Award, University of Cambridge 2021–2026

Doctoral Scholarship, British Society for Philosophy of Science 2022–2025

Stamps Scholarship, Queens' College, University of Cambridge 2022–2025
Awarded full funding for PhD fees and maintenance

Charlton Scholarship, Fitzwilliam College, University of Cambridge 2021–2022
Awarded full funding for MPhil fees and maintenance

Jennifer Redhead Prize, HPS Department, University of Cambridge 2022
Best overall performance on MPhil essays (Distinction, 79%)

T.A. Ryan award, Department of Psychology, Cornell University 2020
Best undergraduate thesis in Psychology

Presentations

Selected conference talks

"The Evaluative Niche Hypothesis"
Philosophy of Science Association, San Diego November 2026

"The Cultural Evolution of Specified Norms"
European Experimental Philosophy Conference, Cagliari September 2026

"From Bad to Wrong"
Society for Philosophy and Psychology, Ithaca June 2025
British Society for Philosophy of Science, Leeds July 2026

"Norm Emergence from Cognitive Biases and Cultural Transmission"
Society for Philosophy and Psychology, Pittsburgh June 2023
European Experimental Philosophy Conference, Zurich September 2023

"From Territoriality to Ownership"
ISHPSSB, Toronto July 2023

"The Principle of Sufficient Reason in Ordinary Thought"
Society for Philosophy and Psychology, Milan July 2022

Invited talks

"Folk Theories of Amusement and Other Emotions"
Jokes in Sciences, University of Cambridge May 2025

"The Principle of Sufficient Reason and Delusional Thought"
The Mental Sciences Club, University of Cambridge May 2024

"Rational Learners and Parochial Norms"
The Sciences of Ethics and Political Philosophy Group, University of Bristol September 2023

"Norm Emergence from Cognitive Biases and Cultural Transmission"
The Mental Sciences Club, University of Cambridge May 2023

"The Principle of Sufficient Reason in Ordinary Thought"
Concepts and Cognition Lab, Princeton University November 2021

Research funding

Cornell Center for Social Sciences, $5,000 — 2026
"The evolution of norms through cognitive biases"
Co-PI (with Shaun Nichols)

Teaching

Undergraduate supervisions, University of Cambridge
Philosophy of Cognitive Science — Lent term 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
Metaphysics (Introduction to Philosophy) — Lent term 2024

Independent Study in Philosophy, Cornell University
Co-advised undergraduate research projects on emotions — Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Spring 2025
Co-advised undergraduate research projects on norms — Spring 2025

Courses prepared to teach **also at the graduate level*

Introductory/survey courses
Philosophy of Science*
Philosophy of AI*
Cognitive Science*
Moral Psychology*
Philosophy of Mind
Metaphysics
Formal Methods: Logic, Decision Theory, Game Theory, Probability and Statistics*

Special topics in philosophy of science
Philosophy of Psychology and Cognitive Science*
Philosophy of Biology*
Philosophy of Psychiatry and Medicine*

Academic service

Co-organizer, session on "How to survive the HPS MPhil" for incoming students — 2022–2025

Co-organizer, departmental reading group on Philosophy of Psychology and Psychiatry — 2026

Member, departmental working group on AI policy — 2026

Peer review for *Philosophy of Science*, *Cognition*, *JEP: General*

References

Marta Halina — mh801@cam.ac.uk
Professor of Philosophy of Science, HPS, University of Cambridge

Tim Lewens — tml1000@cam.ac.uk
Professor of Philosophy of Science, HPS, University of Cambridge

Shaun Nichols — sbn44@cornell.edu
Professor, Philosophy, Cornell University